

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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Dear Backroads hiring team,

I am applying for the Demand Planner role on the Demand Planning team in your Yield Organization, Berkeley HQ. I live in Emeryville, so four days on site is a commute. I bring three years of consulting, which your posting lists as qualifying experience, and two years of IBM operational analytics. I turn performance data into recommendations that partners actually use.

Your 2026 catalog is the widest in company history: more than 270 trips, with planned growth of more than 10 percent. Demand Planning decides which of those trips run, when they depart, and how much capacity they get. I want that seat because it is how the mission becomes a schedule. EMT, AIARE 1, and a CU Boulder capstone on gamifying outdoor education are already how I spend my time.

On the work in your posting:

- **Biannual planning and stakeholder alignment:** I map a team's current process, name the constraint, write the proposal, and stay until they can run the next cycle. An IT MSP's pre-sales assessments dropped 98% in processing time against a measured baseline, then their staff kept the workflow.
- **Trip-performance reviews, in adjacent form:** at IBM I built Tableau and Cognos dashboards for C-level executives in a live Customer Support operation, plus IBMLogAnalyze, which cut 1--3 hours of per-case log prep.
- **When the number and the story disagree:** at Wiz Music I segmented community churn by tenure and joins by source, showed that reported growth was not organic, and raised it with the team. That is the habit I would bring when a departure's story and its numbers disagree.

I have not held a demand-planning title. Booking pace and assortment planning are new. Excel, SQL, Python, Tableau, and Cognos on large datasets are not. I want that recommendation work pointed at guest demand and real capacity.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the chance to walk through how I would read a departure that is behind last year's curve.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker